

SARA STEPHENS

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

August 2021 - Present	Ph.D in Mathematics , Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, USA Advisor: Daniel Halpern-Leistner Expected Graduation: May 2027
September 2017 - May 2021	BSch in Mathematics , Queen's University, Kingston, ON, Canada Major in Mathematics with Distinction

RESEARCH

My research interests are in algebraic geometry, specifically moduli theory, algebraic stacks, enumerative geometry, and quasimaps.

- **Strictly Semistable Quasimaps on the Wall (2026).** [ArXiv]

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2025-2026	Cornell Graduate School Travel Grants \$1400 USD of funding for two international conferences.
2023-2026	NSERC Alexander Graham Bell Canada Graduate Scholarship-Doctoral (CGS-D) \$105,000 CAD of funding for three years. Declined due to pursuing studies outside of Canada.
2023-2026	NSERC Postgraduate Scholarship - Doctoral (PGS-D) \$63,000 CAD of funding for three years. Accepted.
2023	Association for Women in Mathematics Emerging Mathematicians Travel Grant \$500 USD of funding by the Cornell Chapter of the Association for Women in Mathematics.
2021	Cornell University Mathematics First Year Fellowship Funding for first year in graduate school by the Cornell math department.
2020	NSERC Undergraduate Student Research Award Funding to conduct research on <i>Invariant Theory of Reflection Groups</i> with Dr. David Wehlau.
2020	Queen's University Nellie and Ralph Jeffery Award in Mathematics Awarded to a final year mathematics major having the highest standing in mathematics courses.
2019	Queen's University Appeal Undergraduate Scholarship Awarded to an upper-year student with high academic standing in the Faculty of Arts and Science.

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

- July 2026: GAeL XXXIII.
- April 2026: GAPXX—Kyoto. Poster.
- January 2026: Banff International Research Station. Geometry of Algebraic Stacks Workshop. Lightning Talk.
- December 2025: Canadian Mathematical Society Winter Meeting. Algebraic Geometry Special Session.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Spring 2026	Math 1340: Strategy, Cooperation and Conflict. TA, Cornell University.
Fall 2025	Math 1110: Calculus I. Instructor of Record, Cornell University.
Spring 2025	Ithaca High School. Math Seminar Instructor. Designed and taught twenty lessons on the geometry of plane curves for 10th-12th grade.
February 2024	Cornell Graduate Student School Outreach Program. Teaching Fellow. Taught five lessons on projective geometry for 6th grade in a local elementary school.
March 2023	Math Explorer's Club, Instructor. Taught two interactive sessions exploring geometry and set theory for 8-12th grade.
Fall 2022, Spring 2023	Math 2940: Linear Algebra for Engineers. TA, Cornell University.
Fall 2020, Spring 2021	Math 110: Linear Algebra. TA, Queen's University.

OUTREACH AND ORGANIZATION

Spring 2026	AWM Introduction to LaTeX Workshop , Organizer Organized a introduction to LaTeX workshop for STEM undergraduates at Cornell.
Fall 2025, Spring 2026	Cornell Algebraic Geometry Seminar , Organizer Co-organized Cornell's weekly algebraic geometry seminar with faculty.
March 2023	Math Explorer's Club , Instructor Taught four sessions exploring projective geometry and probability for high school girls.
April 2022, April 2023	Expanding Your Horizons , Workshop Leader Co-organized a full day workshop introducing middle school girls to topology.
March 2022	Julia Robinson Math Festival , Organizer Co-organized a virtual workshop exploring mathematical puzzles for 3rd-6th grade.
Fall 2022	Graduate Mentorship Program , Coordinator Co-organized the mentorship program for incoming graduate students.
Spring 2022, Fall 2023	Directed Reading Program , Mentor Mentored four Cornell undergraduates in various reading projects.
Spring 2023	Olivetti Club , Organizer Co-organized Cornell's weekly graduate student seminar.
2022-2024	Association for Women in Mathematics , Mentor Mentored three female Cornell undergraduates interested in pursuing graduate education.